

COOPERATIVE SOCIETY REGISTRATION PACKAGE

Kingdom of Lesotho - Ministry of Small Business Development, Cooperatives and Marketing

DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

This registration package contains all required documents for registering a cooperative society in Lesotho:

- ☐ **Form CS-1:** Application for Registration of Cooperative Society
 - ☐ **Constitution/By-Laws:** Complete cooperative constitution
 - ☐ **Form CS-2:** List of Founding Members and Officials
 - ☐ **Business Plan:** 3-year business plan summary
 - ☐ **Financial Projections:** Basic financial forecasts
 - ☐ **Supporting Documents:** IDs, proof of address, etc.
 - ☐ **Registration Fee:** M 5,000 - M 10,000 (payable to Registrar of Cooperatives)
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FORM CS-1: APPLICATION FOR REGISTRATION

PART A: COOPERATIVE SOCIETY DETAILS

1. Proposed Name of Cooperative:

[PLATFORM NAME] COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LIMITED

Alternative names (if first choice unavailable):

1.
2.

2. Type of Cooperative:

- ☐ Agricultural Cooperative
- ☐ Savings and Credit Cooperative (SACCO)
- ☒ **Financial Services Cooperative**
- ☐ Consumer Cooperative
- ☐ Marketing Cooperative
- ☐ Multi-purpose Cooperative
- ☐ Other: _____

3. Primary Business/Objectives:

To provide digital financial inclusion services by facilitating group-based lending, savings, and financial literacy programs connecting unbanked and underbanked Basotho to formal financial institutions through culturally-appropriate community group structures.

4. Registered Office Address:

Street Address: _____

District: _____ Constituency: _____

Community Council: _____

Village (if applicable): _____

Postal Address: P.O. Box _____, Maseru, Lesotho

Phone: (+266) _____

Email: _____

Website: _____

5. Geographic Area of Operation:

- ☒ National (All 10 districts)
- ☐ District-specific: _____
- ☐ Local (specific communities): _____

6. Number of Founding Members: [_____]

Minimum required: 7 members

7. Estimated Future Membership:

- Year 1: _____ members
- Year 3: _____ members
- Year 5: _____ members

8. Share Capital:

- Par value per share: M _____
 - Minimum shares per member: _____
 - Maximum shares per member: _____
 - Initial subscribed capital: M _____
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PART B: FOUNDING MEMBERS & OFFICIALS

List all founding members (minimum 7 required)

Member 1 (Proposed Chairperson)

Full Name: _____

ID Number: _____ Gender: ☐ M ☐ F

Date of Birth: _____

Residential Address: _____

District: _____ Phone: _____

Email: _____

Occupation: _____

Number of Shares: _____ Share Value: M _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Member 2 (Proposed Secretary)

Full Name: _____

ID Number: _____ Gender: ☐ M ☐ F

Date of Birth: _____

Residential Address: _____

District: _____ Phone: _____

Email: _____

Occupation: _____

Number of Shares: _____ Share Value: M _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Member 3 (Proposed Treasurer)

Full Name: _____

ID Number: _____ Gender: ☐ M ☐ F

Date of Birth: _____

Residential Address: _____

District: _____ Phone: _____

Email: _____

Occupation: _____

Number of Shares: _____ Share Value: M _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Members 4-7 (Additional Founding Members)

Complete similar details for each member

[Attach Form CS-2 with complete list if more than 7 founding members]

PART C: MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE

Initial Management Committee (elected by founding members):

Position	Name	ID Number	Term
Chairperson			[2] years
Vice-Chairperson			[2] years
Secretary			[2] years
Treasurer			[2] years
Committee Member			[2] years
Committee Member			[2] years
Committee Member			[2] years

Gender Balance: Minimum [30]% representation of each gender required.

PART D: DECLARATIONS

Declaration by Founding Members:

We, the undersigned founding members, hereby declare that:

1. We have voluntarily come together to form this cooperative society;
2. We understand the cooperative principles and are committed to them;

3. All information provided in this application is true and correct;
4. We have read and agree to abide by the proposed constitution/by-laws;
5. We authorize [Name] _____ to act as our representative in registration matters;
6. We shall pay all required share capital and registration fees;
7. We understand our rights and obligations as cooperative members.

Signatures of All Founding Members:

[Table for signatures, dates, and witness]

Declaration by Authorized Representative:

I, _____, being duly authorized by the founding members, hereby submit this application for registration and certify that all documents attached are authentic and complete.

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Position: _____

PART E: FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Application Received By:

Name: _____ Signature: _____

Date Received: _____ Reference Number: _____

Registration Fee Paid:

Receipt Number: _____ Amount: M _____ Date: _____

Registration Decision:

- ☐ Approved - Registration Certificate Issued
- ☐ Conditional Approval - Additional information required
- ☐ Rejected - Reason: _____

Registration Number: CS-_____

Date of Registration: _____

Registrar's Signature: _____

Official Stamp:

CONSTITUTION OF [COOPERATIVE NAME]

PREAMBLE

We, the members of [COOPERATIVE NAME], recognizing the power of cooperation to improve our economic and social well-being, hereby establish this cooperative society in accordance with the Cooperative Societies Act 2000 of Lesotho and in the spirit of the International Cooperative Principles.

ARTICLE 1: NAME, REGISTERED OFFICE & AREA OF OPERATION

1.1 Name

The name of this society shall be [PLATFORM NAME] COOPERATIVE SOCIETY LIMITED (hereinafter "the Cooperative").

1.2 Registered Office

The registered office shall be located at [Full Address], or such other place as the Annual General Meeting may determine.

1.3 Area of Operation

The Cooperative shall operate throughout the Kingdom of Lesotho, with priority focus on underserved rural and peri-urban communities.

ARTICLE 2: DEFINITIONS

In this Constitution, unless the context otherwise requires:

"**Act**" means the Cooperative Societies Act 2000 and any regulations made thereunder.

"**Board**" or "**Management Committee**" means the elected management committee of the Cooperative.

"**Borrower Group**" means a self-organized group of individuals (Stokvel, Burial Society, Employer Union, Savings Group, etc.) registered with the Cooperative to access group-based financial services.

"**Member**" means a person admitted to membership in accordance with this Constitution.

"**Platform**" means the digital technology platform operated by the Cooperative for facilitating financial services connections.

"**Registrar**" means the Registrar of Cooperatives appointed under the Act.

"**Year**" means the financial year of the Cooperative ending on [date, e.g., 31st March].

ARTICLE 3: OBJECTIVES & POWERS

3.1 Primary Objectives

The objectives of the Cooperative are to: